

Hawaiian Coot Website

Opening Cinematic Sequence Master Guide

This document contains the complete cinematic opening sequence design and implementation guide for the Hawaiian Coot endangered species website. The goal of the opening sequence is to create the emotional feeling of flying into Hawaii and discovering a hidden wetland ecosystem before revealing the interactive homepage. The intro should feel cinematic, immersive, peaceful, emotional, and visually stunning.

1. OVERALL EXPERIENCE GOAL

- The intro sequence should feel like entering a nature documentary.
 - The viewer should feel transported into Hawaii.
 - The transition into the homepage should feel magical.
 - The sequence should build emotional immersion before revealing the interactive UI.
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2. INTRO SEQUENCE FLOW

- Scene 1 — Ocean Fly-In
 - Scene 2 — Hawaiian Islands Reveal
 - Scene 3 — Wetland Descent
 - Scene 4 — Hawaiian Coot Reveal
 - Scene 5 — Homepage Activation
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3. SCENE 1 — OCEAN FLY-IN

- Duration: 2 seconds
 - Aerial cloud layer
 - Pacific Ocean visible below
 - Golden sunrise horizon
 - Slow cinematic camera movement
 - Soft atmospheric fog
 - Ambient ocean lighting
 - Subtle floating particles
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4. SCENE 2 — HAWAIIAN ISLANDS REVEAL

- Duration: 2 seconds
 - Hawaiian mountains emerge through clouds
 - Palm silhouettes visible
 - Tropical sunrise atmosphere
 - Birds flying across screen
 - Lens flare effects
 - Light rays through clouds
 - Text overlay appears:
 - “Every Wetland Tells a Story”
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5. SCENE 3 — WETLAND DESCENT

- Duration: 2 seconds
 - Camera descends toward wetlands
 - Water reflections appear
 - Lily pads become visible
 - Tropical reeds and vegetation
 - Atmospheric fog and light rays
 - Environmental cinematic glow
 - Subtle water shimmer
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6. SCENE 4 — HAWAIIAN COOT REVEAL

- Duration: 2 seconds
 - Hawaiian Coot appears at center
 - Sunlight behind bird silhouette
 - Water ripple effects
 - Glowing ecosystem particles
 - Orbital energy ring begins forming
 - Homepage atmosphere begins activating
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7. SCENE 5 — HOMEPAGE ACTIVATION

- Duration: 1 second
- Radial menu fades in

- Menu nodes illuminate sequentially
 - Side panels appear
 - Scroll prompt fades in
 - Homepage becomes interactive
 - Final frame must match homepage design exactly
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8. VISUAL DESIGN LANGUAGE

- Cinematic tropical wetland atmosphere
 - Emerald green ecosystem glow
 - Sunset gold reflections
 - Ocean cyan highlights
 - Glassmorphism UI panels
 - National Geographic + futuristic ecosystem aesthetic
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9. ANIMATION STYLE

- All movement must feel smooth and organic
 - Use floating motion
 - Use cinematic easing
 - Avoid fast or aggressive motion
 - Use water-like movement behavior
 - Use subtle ecosystem particle animation
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10. AUDIO DESIGN

- Soft tropical wind ambience
 - Distant bird sounds
 - Gentle water ambience
 - Subtle cinematic music rise
 - Audio should remain soft and atmospheric
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11. TECHNICAL STACK

- HTML5
- CSS3

- Vanilla JavaScript
 - GSAP animation library
 - Optional Three.js for advanced particles
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12. FILE STRUCTURE

- /assets/backgrounds/
 - /assets/birds/
 - /assets/ui/
 - /assets/audio/
 - index.html
 - style.css
 - script.js
 - intro.js
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13. GSAP ANIMATION REQUIREMENTS

- Fade transitions between scenes
 - Camera zoom movement
 - Particle fade animations
 - Orbital glow activation
 - Homepage fade-in sequence
 - Floating UI activation
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14. SKIP BUTTON

- Add skip intro button in upper-right corner
 - Button should instantly reveal homepage
 - Transitions should remain smooth
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15. PERFORMANCE REQUIREMENTS

- Optimize all cinematic images
- Use hardware acceleration
- Use lazy loading
- Maintain smooth FPS

- Avoid heavy lag from particles or blur effects
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16. FINAL DESIGN GOAL

- The intro should feel like:
 - - flying into Hawaii
 - - discovering a hidden ecosystem
 - - entering a futuristic environmental interface
 - - beginning an immersive conservation journey
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This document should be used as the primary implementation reference for building the cinematic opening experience of the Hawaiian Coot website. All motion, atmosphere, lighting, transitions, and interactions should follow this specification closely.